

24. Congo is situated in –

- (a) Africa (b) Asia
(c) Europe (d) North America

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (a)

The Democratic Republic of the Congo is located in Africa. Democratic Republic of the Congo is situated at the Equator. It is the second largest country in Africa after Algeria. Republic of Congo is also a country in Africa and Equator passes through it.

25. In which one of the following is Malta located?

- (a) Baltic Sea
(b) Mediterranean Sea
(c) Black Sea
(d) North Sea

I.A.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

The small island country of Malta is located in southern Europe. It is situated in the Mediterranean Sea.

26. What is the correct sequence of the following cities in south-east Asia as one proceeds from south to north?

1. Bangkok 2. Hanoi
3. Jakarta 4. Singapore

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) 4-2-1-3 (b) 3-2-4-1
(c) 3-4-1-2 (d) 4-3-2-1

I.A.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (c)

The correct sequence of the above cities in south-east Asia as one proceeds from south to north is as follows:

(Cities)		(approx Latitudes Position)
Jakarta	-	6°12'S
Singapore	-	1.3°N
Bangkok	-	13°45'N
Hanoi	-	21°2'N

27. Consider the following pairs :

Towns sometimes mentioned in news		Country
1. Aleppo	-	Syria
2. Kirkuk	-	Yemen
3. Mosul	-	Palestine
4. Mazar-i-sharif	-	Afghanistan

Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 1 and 4
(c) 2 and 3 (d) 3 and 4

I.A.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (b)

Aleppo is in Syria, Kirkuk and Mosul in Iraq, while Mazar-i-Sharif is located in Afghanistan. It is clear that pair 1 and 4 are correctly matched.

28. Which of the following city/cities is/are not situated in present day Afghanistan?

1. Ghazni 2. Fergana 3. Kandahar 4. Samarkand

Select the correct answer from the code given below :

Code :

- (a) 2 and 3 (b) Only 4
(c) 2 and 4 (d) Only 1

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

Ghazni and Kandahar are located in Afghanistan, while Fergana and Samarkand are located in Uzbekistan.

Geographical Sobriquets

There are many countries in this world that are often known by their geographical sobriquets. ***Midnight Sun** is a natural phenomenon that occurs in the summer months in places north of the Arctic Circle or south of the Antarctic Circle when the sun remains visible at local midnight. *Around the summer solstice (approximately 21 June in the Northern Hemisphere and 22 December in the Southern Hemisphere), the sun is visible for a full 24 hours. Thus countries like Norway which lies in the Arctic region experience 24 hours of daylight, a reason why it is often called the **Land of Midnight sun**. Norway is the best-suited example of the phenomenon of Midnight Sun even though parts of other countries like Canada, Sweden, Russia, Iceland, and Finland are also located north of the Arctic Circle and experience a Midnight Sun. *In the Southern Hemisphere there is no country situated between the Antarctic Circle and the South Pole. * Out of the 11000 species of birds found on this planet, around 3402 bird species are found in South America. Hence South America is also known as the '**Bird Continent**'. * '**Mistress of the Eastern Sea**' is a geographical Sobriquet of Sri Lanka. Sri Lanka is located north of the equator. The country lies to the South-East of the Indian sub-continent separated by Gulf of Mannar and the Palk Strait. Sri Lanka is located in the Indian Ocean and is often referred to as the '**Pearl of Indian Ocean**'. Singapore is called the '**Gateway to Asia**'. * Thailand is the country that is also called the '**Land of white elephants**', as it has a large number of White elephants and the white elephants are the symbol of royal power in Thailand. It is believed that if the King of Thailand was unsatisfied with the work of any

of his associates, he would gift him a white elephant, which would turn the man bankrupt. ***Nippon** refers to Japan. It means the 'Land of Rising Sun'. *Thus Japan is known as the **Land of the Rising Sun**. *The thousands of lakes in Finland are the reason why the country's nickname is '**The Land of a Thousand Lakes**'. *South Korea is known as the '**Land of Morning Calm**'. Istanbul, the former capital of Turkiye is a major tourist destination. Since it is a transcontinental city it is also known as the '**Gateway of the West**'. *Venice is known as the '**City of Canals**'. Venice is one of the most beautiful cities in the world. Venice (Italy) is also known as '**City of Dreams**'. *Osaka is a designated city in the Kansai region of Japan. It is also known as '**Manchester of the East**'. However historically the city of Osaka is also known as 'Nation's Kitchen'. *The Golden Gate Bridge is a suspension bridge that connects the two ends of the Bay of San Francisco. It is the reason why San Francisco is also known as the '**City of Golden Gate**'. *The problem of smoking became so severe in Chicago that an ordinance had to be passed in 2005 to ban smoking. Chicago is hence also known as **City of Smokers**. The Eiffel Tower is a wrought – iron lattice tower in Paris, France. It is named after the engineer Gustave Eiffel, whose company designed and built the tower; including the 24 meter long antenna. The tower is 1083 feet (330 m.) tall. *Pamir Knot is known as the **roof of the world**. The Pamir Knot makes up the Southern border of Central Asia. *Bahrain is known as the **Island of Pearls**. It is also known as '**Pearl of Persian Gulf**'. *Lake Baikal is located in Siberia (Russia). It is also known as '**Pearl of Siberia**.' *Buenos Aires is the capital of Argentina and is also known as '**Paris of South America**'.

Sobriquets	Place
Gift of Nile	Egypt
City of Seven Hills	Rome (Italy)
Eternal City	Rome (Italy)
Queen of Adriatic	Venice (Italy)
Island of Cloves	Zanzibar
Land of Thunderbolts	Bhutan
Land of Canals	Pakistan
Empire City	New York (US)
Dark Continent	Africa
Pearl of Antilles	Cuba
Sugar Bowl of the World	Cuba
Land of Golden Pagodas	Myanmar
Land of Kangaroos	Australia
Britain of South	New Zealand
Key of Mediterranean	Gibraltar
Holy Land	Palestine / Jerusalem

Sick Man of Europe	Turkiye
Playground of Europe	Switzerland
The Sorrow of China	River Hwang Ho
World's Bread Basket	Prairies of North America
City of Golden Temple	Amritsar
Land of Five Rivers	Punjab
The Sorrow of Bengal	River Damodar
Gateway of India	Mumbai
Queen of Arabian Sea	Kochi (Cochin)
Spice Garden of India	Kerala
Switzerland of India	Kashmir
City of Seven Islands	Mumbai
Twin Cities	Hyderabad-Secunderabad
The Sorrow of Bihar	River Kosi
Queen of Chotanagpur	Netarhat (Jharkhand)
Queen of Mountains (India)	Mussoorie
Manchester of India	Ahmedabad
Venice of East	Alappuzha (Alleppey)
	Udaipur

1. Name the city of Russia that is known as 'Venice of North'.

- (a) Vladivostok (b) St. Petersburg
(c) Novosibirsk (d) Moscow
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

66th B.P.C.S. (Pre) (Re-Exam) 2020

Ans. (b)

Saint Petersburg is a city in Russia that is located on the Neva River. St. Petersburg is one of a group of 7 cities often called, "The Venice of the North"; it shares this name with Amsterdam, Bruges, Copenhagen, Hamburg, Manchester and Stockholm.

2. The midnight sun appears at-

- (a) North Pole (b) South Pole
(c) Equator (d) Tropic of Cancer

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (a & b)

The midnight sun is a natural phenomenon that occurs in places north of the Arctic Circle or south of the Antarctic Circle. Between these circles and the poles, the sun is visible for a full 24 hours. Accordingly, in countries like Norway, situated on the Arctic Circle, the sun is visible even during the night. This is why Norway is known as the country of the midnight sun.

3. Which of the following is known as 'the Continent of Birds'?

- (a) Europe (b) Australia
(c) South America (d) Asia

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

11000 species of birds worldwide and around 3402 bird species found in the South American continent. That is why the South America is often called a (Bird continent).

4. Match the following-

- A. Niagara Falls 1. Pamir
B. The land of thousand lakes 2. Paris
C. Eiffel Tower 3. Finland
D. The Roof of the World 4. New York State

Code :

- | A | B | C | D |
|-------|---|---|---|
| (a) 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 |
| (b) 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 |
| (c) 1 | 2 | 4 | 3 |
| (d) 4 | 1 | 3 | 2 |

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

Niagara Falls is located in North America on the *Niagara River* on the border of the United States of America and Canada.

Finland is often called the land of a thousand lakes.

Eiffel Tower is situated in Paris. Gustave Eiffel, a French civil engineer, is credited with designing the tower that bears his name. The Eiffel Tower is 330 meters tall.

Pamir Plateau is also known as the **Roof of the World**. It is the meeting point of several mountains. The southern border of Central Asia is determined by the Pamir Plateau.

5. Match the following-

- A. Dark Continent 1. Finland
B. The Roof of the World 2. Bahrain
C. Country of thousand lakes 3. Africa
D. Pearls Island 4. Pamir

Code :

- | A | B | C | D |
|-------|---|---|---|
| (a) 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 |
| (b) 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 |
| (c) 2 | 1 | 4 | 3 |
| (d) 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

The description of the following geographical names is as follows-

- | | | |
|---------------------------|---|---------------|
| Dark Continent | - | Africa |
| The Roof of the World | - | Pamir Plateau |
| Country of thousand lakes | - | Finland |
| Pearls Island | - | Bahrain |

6. Which of the following city is known by the name of the city of smoke?

- (a) Kolkata (b) Chicago
(c) London (d) Lanzhou

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

The problem of smoking in Chicago was so huge that the government had to bring an ordinance in the year 2005 to ban smoking. Chicago is also known as the 'city of smoke'.

7. Which of the following is known as 'Mistress of Eastern Sea'?

- (a) Sri Lanka (b) Pakistan
(c) Burma (d) India

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

'The Mistress of the Eastern Sea' title is given to Sri Lanka. Sri Lanka is an island situated in the Indian Ocean, at the base of the Indian Sub-Continent, 880 km north of the Equator. It is also known as 'The Pearl of Indian Ocean'.

8. The Ninety East Ridge (90° East Ridge) is located in which of the following oceans?

- (a) Arctic Ocean (b) Atlantic Ocean
(c) Pacific Ocean (d) Indian Ocean

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

9. Which city of South America is known as 'The Paris of America' due to its wide roads?

- (a) Santiago (b) Buenos Aires
(c) Mexico City (d) Rio de Janeiro

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (b)

Buenos Aires is the capital and largest city of Argentina. It is also known as 'the Paris of South America'.

10. Which state of the U.S.A. is also known as the 'Blue Grass State'?

- (a) California (b) Kentucky

- (c) Montana (d) Texas

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2004

Ans. (b)

Kentucky, situated in East South-Central region of the USA is also known as the "Blue Grass State".

11. Which city of Turkey is known as the 'Gateway to the West' ?

- (a) Adana (b) Ankara
(c) Istanbul (d) Izmir

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (c)

Istanbul is located in the peninsular area of Turkiye whose three sides are surrounded by the Marmara Sea, Bosphorus Straits and Golden Horn. It is also known as the Gateway to the West'.

12. Which country is called "Land of White Elephants"?

- (a) China (b) Thailand
(c) South Africa (d) South Korea

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (b)

Thailand is also known as the 'Land of White Elephants'. The white elephant is considered holy in Thailand.

13. Which country is famous by the name of the land of the rising sun?

- (a) Norway (b) Japan
(c) Britain (d) Finland

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (b)

Japanese also call their country Nippon which means the land of the rising sun. Thus, Japan is also known as the land of the rising sun.

14. Which of the following countries is called 'Garden of Lakes'?

- (a) Poland (b) Finland
(c) Netherlands (d) Switzerland

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012

Ans. (b)

Finland is also called 'the Garden of Lakes' or the Land of a Thousand Lakes. More than one lakh lakes are found in Finland.

15. Which of the following cities is known as the 'city of canals'?

- (a) Amsterdam (b) Rome
(c) Venice (d) Athens

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (c)

Venice is known as the city of canals. It is one of the most beautiful cities in the world. It is also known as the 'Queen of the Adriatic'.

16. Which one of the following is known as the city of the golden gate ?

- (a) Paris (b) Amsterdam
(c) Mumbai (d) San Francisco

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (d)

Golden Gate Bridge is located in San Francisco city and connects both ends of San Francisco Bay. Therefore, San Francisco is known as the city of the golden gate'.

17. Which of the following cities is called 'Manchester of East'?

- (a) Nagoya (b) Tokyo
(c) Sendai (d) Osaka

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (d)

Osaka (Japan) is called 'Manchester of the East'. Osaka city is located in the Kansai region of Japan. It is the capital city of Osaka province. Historically the trade city Osaka is also famous by the name of 'Nation's Kitchen'.

18. Which one of the following is called the 'Pearl of Siberia'?

- (a) Baikal Lake (b) Great Bear Lake
(c) Karda Lake (d) Lincanbur Lake

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

Lake Baikal is the world's oldest and deepest freshwater lake. Lake Baikal is called "Pearl of Siberia".

19. Which one of the following is called the 'Land of Morning calm'?

- (a) Philippines (b) Japan
(c) Taiwan (d) Korea

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

South Korea is called 'Land of Morning Calm' because of its spellbinding natural beauty, high mountains, clear waters, and its splendid tranquility, particularly in the morning.